alliance, but also a regional, alliance, geo-cultural alliance'.[90] Ten regional parties joined at the time. Since then, some have left and others have joined, while some remained members of the regional alliance even as they also fought electoral battles with the BJP at the state level. As the scholar Tarun Gogoi (no connection to the Congress MP by the same name) has pointed out, NEDA can be seen as a 'strategic move for BJP to exploit the anti-Congress sentiment among regional parties and garner it for their electoral benefit as well as expand their support base as insider party in a localised form'.[91] In other words, regional parties became conduits for the BJP's expansion. In the 2014 Lok Sabha poll, the party had only won eight of twenty-five seats. By 2019, the BJP had won fourteen seats on its own, while NEDA won eighteen seats. In effect, the coalition helped shrink the electoral space for the Congress in the region (see Table 16.2).

Table 16.2: The Role of NEDA in Expanding the BJP's Footprint in the Northeast: 2019 General Election Results

State	*Congress*		*BJP*		*NEDA*	
	Seats	*Vote %*	*Seats*	*Vote %*	*Seats*	*Vote*
Arunachal Pradesh (2)	0	20.69	2	58.22	2	58.22
Assam (14)	3	35.44	9	36.05	9	46.76
Manipur (2)	0	24.63	1	34.22	2	56.7
Meghalaya (2)	1	48.28	0	7.93	1	30.2
Mizoram (1)	-	-	0	5.75	1	50.64
Nagaland (1)	0	48.11	-	-	1	49.73
Sikkim (1)	0	1.13	0	4.71	0	48.64
Tripura (2)	0	25.34	2	49.03	2	53.19
North-East India (25)	4	33.6	14	33.7	18	-

Source: ECI data, Tarun Gogoi, 'North East Democratic Alliance (NEDA) and Political Change in Northeast India', Dialogue, *Vol. 20, No. 4, 2019, p. 116. Cumulative Northeast vote percentage data for BJP and Congress from Nalin Mehta, Rishabh Srivastava, PollNiti, https://pollniti.com/live.html#!*